

Habakkuk

¹ The burden which Habakkuk the prophet did see.

² O LORD, how long shall I cry, and thou wilt not hear! *even* cry out unto thee of violence, and thou wilt not save!

³ Why dost thou shew me iniquity, and cause *me* to behold grievance? for spoiling and violence *are* before me: and there are *that* raise up strife and contention.

⁴ Therefore the law is slacked, and judgment doth never go forth: for the wicked doth compass about the righteous; therefore wrong judgment proceedeth.*

⁵ ¶ Behold ye among the heathen, and regard, and wonder marvellously: for *I* will work a work in your days, *which* ye will not believe, though it be told *you*.

⁶ For, lo, I raise up the Chaldeans, *that* bitter and hasty nation, which shall march through the breadth of the land, to possess the dwellingplaces *that are* not theirs.†

⁷ They *are* terrible and dreadful: their judgment and their dignity shall proceed of themselves.‡

⁸ Their horses also are swifter than the leopards, and are more fierce than the evening wolves: and their horsemen shall spread themselves, and their horsemen shall come from far; they shall fly as the eagle *that* hasteth to eat.§

⁹ They shall come all for violence: their faces shall sup up *as* the east wind, and they shall gather the captivity *as* the sand.**

¹⁰ And they shall scoff at the kings, and the princes shall be a scorn unto them: they shall deride every strong hold; for they shall heap dust, and take it.

¹¹ Then shall *his* mind change, and he shall pass over, and offend, *imputing* this his power unto his god.

¹² ¶ *Art* thou not from everlasting, O LORD my God, mine Holy One? we shall not die. O LORD, thou hast ordained them for judgment; and, O mighty God, thou hast established them for correction.††‡‡

¹³ *Thou art* of purer eyes than to behold evil, and canst not look on iniquity: wherefore lookest thou upon them that deal treacherously, *and* holdest thy tongue when the wicked devoureth *the man that is* more righteous than he?§§

¹⁴ And makest men as the fishes of the sea, as the creeping things, *that have* no ruler over them?***

¹⁵ They take up all of them with the angle, they catch them in their net, and gather them in their drag: therefore they rejoice and are glad.†††

¹⁶ Therefore they sacrifice unto their net, and burn incense unto their drag; because by them their portion is fat, and their meat plenteous.‡‡‡

¹⁷ Shall they therefore empty their net, and not spare continually to slay the nations?

2

¹ I will stand upon my watch, and set me upon the tower, and will watch to see what he will say unto me, and what I shall answer when I am reproved.*†‡

* 1:4 wrong: or, wrested † 1:6 breadth: Heb. breadths ‡ 1:7 their judgment...: or, from them shall proceed the judgment of these, and the captivity of these § 1:8 fierce: Heb. sharp ** 1:9 their...: or, the supping up of their faces, etc: or, their faces shall look (Heb. the opposition of their faces) toward the east †† 1:12 mighty...: Heb. rock ‡‡ 1:12 established: Heb. founded §§ 1:13 iniquity: or, grievance *** 1:14 creeping: or, moving ††† 1:15 drag: or, flue net ‡‡‡ 1:16 plenteous: or, dainty: Heb. fat * 2:1 tower: Heb. fenced place † 2:1 unto me: or, in me ‡ 2:1 when...: or, when I am argued with: Heb. upon my reproof, or, arguing

² And the LORD answered me, and said, Write the vision, and make *it* plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.

³ For the vision *is* yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.

⁴ Behold, his soul *which* is lifted up is not upright in him: but the just shall live by his faith.

⁵ ¶ Yea also, because he transgresseth by wine, *he is* a proud man, neither keepeth at home, who enlargeth his desire as hell, and *is* as death, and cannot be satisfied, but gathereth unto him all nations, and heapeth unto him all people:§

⁶ Shall not all these take up a parable against him, and a taunting proverb against him, and say, Woe to him that increaseth *that which* is not his! how long? and to him that ladeth himself with thick clay!***

⁷ Shall they not rise up suddenly that shall bite thee, and awake that shall vex thee, and thou shalt be for booties unto them?

⁸ Because thou hast spoiled many nations, all the remnant of the people shall spoil thee; because of men's blood, and *for* the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.††

⁹ ¶ Woe to him that coveteth an evil covetousness to his house, that he may set his nest on high, that he may be delivered from the power of evil!‡‡§§

¹⁰ Thou hast consulted shame to thy house by cutting off many people, and hast sinned *against* thy soul.

¹¹ For the stone shall cry out of the wall, and the beam out of the timber shall answer it.***†††

¹² ¶ Woe to him that buildeth a town with blood, and stablisheth a city by iniquity!‡‡‡

¹³ Behold, *is it* not of the LORD of hosts that the people shall labour in the very fire, and the people shall weary themselves for very vanity?§§§

¹⁴ For the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.*

¹⁵ ¶ Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink, that puttest thy bottle to *him*, and makest *him* drunken also, that thou mayest look on their nakedness!

¹⁶ Thou art filled with shame for glory: drink thou also, and let thy foreskin be uncovered: the cup of the LORD's right hand shall be turned unto thee, and shameful spewing *shall be* on thy glory.†

¹⁷ For the violence of Lebanon shall cover thee, and the spoil of beasts, *which* made them afraid, because of men's blood, and for the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.

¹⁸ ¶ What profiteth the graven image that the maker thereof hath graven it; the molten image, and a teacher of lies, that the maker of his work trusteth therein, to make dumb idols?‡

¹⁹ Woe unto him that saith to the wood, Awake; to the dumb stone, Arise, it shall teach! Behold, it *is* laid over with gold and silver, and *there is* no breath at all in the midst of it.

²⁰ But the LORD *is* in his holy temple: let all the earth keep silence before him.§

§ 2:5 Yea...: or, How much more ** 2:6 Woe...: or, Ho, he †† 2:8 blood: Heb. bloods ‡‡ 2:9 coveteth...: or, gaineth and evil gain §§ 2:9 power...: Heb. palm of the hand *** 2:11 beam: or, piece, or, fastening ††† 2:11 answer it: or, witness against it ‡‡‡ 2:12 blood: Heb. bloods §§§ 2:13 for...: or, in vain? * 2:14 with...: or, by knowing the glory † 2:16 with...: or, more with shame than with glory ‡ 2:18 maker of...: Heb. fashioner of his fashion § 2:20 let...: Heb. be silent all the earth before him

3

¹ A prayer of Habakkuk the prophet upon Shigionoth.*

² O LORD, I have heard thy speech, *and* was afraid: O LORD, revive thy work in the midst of the years, in the midst of the years make known; in wrath remember mercy.††

³ God came from Teman, and the Holy One from mount Paran. Selah. His glory covered the heavens, and the earth was full of his praise.§

⁴ And *his* brightness was as the light; he had horns *coming* out of his hand: and there was the hiding of his power.**

⁵ Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet.††

⁶ He stood, and measured the earth: he beheld, and drove asunder the nations; and the everlasting mountains were scattered, the perpetual hills did bow: his ways *are* everlasting.

⁷ I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction: *and* the curtains of the land of Midian did tremble.‡§§

⁸ Was the LORD displeased against the rivers? *was* thine anger against the rivers? *was* thy wrath against the sea, that thou didst ride upon thine horses *and* thy chariots of salvation?***

⁹ Thy bow was made quite naked, *according* to the oaths of the tribes, *even* thy word. Selah. Thou didst cleave the earth with rivers.†††

¹⁰ The mountains saw thee, *and* they trembled: the overflowing of the water passed by: the deep uttered his voice, *and* lifted up his hands on high.

¹¹ The sun *and* moon stood still in their habitation: at the light of thine arrows they went, *and* at the shining of thy glittering spear.‡‡‡

¹² Thou didst march through the land in indignation, thou didst thresh the heathen in anger.

¹³ Thou wentest forth for the salvation of thy people, *even* for salvation with thine anointed; thou woundedst the head out of the house of the wicked, by discovering the foundation unto the neck. Selah. §§§

¹⁴ Thou didst strike through with his staves the head of his villages: they came out as a whirlwind to scatter me: their rejoicing *was* as to devour the poor secretly.*

¹⁵ Thou didst walk through the sea with thine horses, *through* the heap of great waters.†

¹⁶ When I heard, my belly trembled; my lips quivered at the voice: rottenness entered into my bones, and I trembled in myself, that I might rest in the day of trouble: when he cometh up unto the people, he will invade them with his troops.‡

¹⁷ ¶ Although the fig tree shall not blossom, neither *shall* fruit *be* in the vines; the labour of the olive shall fail, and the fields shall yield no meat; the flock shall be cut off from the fold, and *there shall be* no herd in the stalls:§

¹⁸ Yet I will rejoice in the LORD, I will joy in the God of my salvation.

¹⁹ The LORD God *is* my strength, and he will make my feet like hinds' *feet*, and he will make me to walk upon mine high places. To the chief singer on my stringed instruments.**††

* 3:1 upon...: or, according to variable songs, or, tunes, called in Hebrew, Shigionoth † 3:2 speech: Heb. report, or, hearing ‡ 3:2 revive: or, preserve alive § 3:3 Teman: or, the south ** 3:4 horns...: or, bright beams out of his side †† 3:5 coals: or, diseases ‡‡ 3:7 Cushan: or, Ethiopia §§ 3:7 in...: or, under affliction, or, vanity *** 3:8 of...: or, were salvation? ††† 3:9 earth...: or, rivers of the earth ‡‡‡ 3:11 at the light...: or, thine arrows walked in the light §§§ 3:13 by...: Heb. making naked * 3:14 came...: Heb. were tempestuous † 3:15 heap: or, mud ‡ 3:16 invade...: or, cut them in pieces § 3:17 fail: Heb. lie ** 3:19 chief...: or, overseer †† 3:19 stringed...: Heb. Neginoth